



PROGRESS REPORT

Standards: progress report, 2025-08-01 to 2026-08-27

Edition of 2026-08-27-3 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

3 places. Every table below is carried verbatim from that place's own progress report; nothing is written here.

AFRICA · SOUTHERN AFRICA · WEST AFRICA

Movement values. *Advanced* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a measured position worsened. *Closed* — the programme ended. *No change* — the position at both ends is the same. *Baseline not held* — the base carries no position at the start of the period, so no movement can be stated. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Advanced, slipped*.

Africa

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-27	MOVEMENT
Africa PKI Forum harmonisation of digital-trust rules	Did not exist	Participants called for harmonised African rules so that digital credentials, electronic signatures and documents can be verified across borders; nothing is adopted and no instrument, timetable or signatory list is on file	ADVANCED
African Common Proposals for WRC-27	Preliminary African Common Proposals for WRC-27 and RA-27 are to be consolidated from the recommendations of the African Telecommunications Union's WRC-27 working groups at the third African Preparatory Meeting, Tunis, 7-11 September 2026, co-organised with Tunisia's Agence Nationale des Frequences; no proposal text is published	The union's third radiocommunication working group met as an e-meeting convened from Nairobi from 18 to 21 August 2026, input contributions having closed on 11 August, to prepare its recommendations for the third African Preparatory Meeting; the meeting's own output is not published, and no proposal text is published	ADVANCED

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-27	MOVEMENT
AFRINIC Constitution (Bylaws)	BASELINE NOT HELD	Fifth version in force since December 2020; the Bylaws Review Committee ran a first consultation from 2026-04-20, extended on 2026-05-08 to close 2026-05-17, and published a draft amended Constitution on 2026-08-04 for a second consultation closing 2026-08-21. It names membership, powers of members, the Nomination Committee and appointment of directors as the most heavily revised provisions, and a new Article 3 would write into the constitution that AFRINIC is the Regional Internet Registry for Africa and the Indian Ocean and that its governance will be periodically reviewed against internationally recognised governance standards. The published-draft milestone slipped about six weeks against the Committee's own indicative timetable while the Special General Members Meeting stayed in September 2026, and no consolidation or analysis of the first round's submissions is published; a second draft was open for comment from 4 to 21 August 2026. Proposed article 9.8 would let a two-thirds board vote revoke the nomination committee and restart an election the board itself had judged to have failed, with the same board defining the failure, deciding the case and triggering the consequence before any independent review; the current rule barring a conflicted director from voting would be dropped and recusal relocated into board policy, which matters because Mauritius company law lets an interested director vote after disclosure unless the constitution says otherwise; article 16 opens a wide advice channel with no register of advice given or received; and article 17.5 would create an acting chief executive office with no maximum term and no stated link to board seat 9 or to removal rules. A cyberdiplomacy consultant who had opposed early constitutional reform argued on 19 August that the article-by-article rationale now gives members enough to test the draft against the failures it is meant to fix	<i>Baseline not held</i>
Continental ICT standardisation alignment	BASELINE NOT HELD	Talks opened on a coordinated continental approach across the standards lifecycle, from development through harmonised adoption and implementation by countries, naming fragmentation and the failure to translate continental and international standards into national frameworks as the problem	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Southern Africa

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-27	MOVEMENT
Lilongwe Declaration on Collaborative Regulation	Did not exist	Adopted with six shared principles and seven areas of collaborative action; CRASA has not published the text (2026-08-05)	ADVANCED
Regional data governance harmonisation roadmap	Did not exist	Policymakers, regulators and technical experts from eight Southern African states worked towards a roadmap for harmonising data governance frameworks, at a workshop convened by a UN agency with a continental digital body and a member state ministry, working from a data governance toolkit and undertaking national self-assessments	ADVANCED
SADC One Network Area roaming framework	Reduced rates between Botswana and Namibia only (2024-08)	Six states applying harmonised tariffs, with cuts between 10% and 98.6%	ADVANCED

West Africa

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-27	MOVEMENT
Alliance ouest-africaine des noms de domaine (AOAN)	Did not exist	Announced as an initiative to coordinate country-code domain policy across the region; no charter, membership or founding act held	ADVANCED
ECOWAS free-roaming regulation C/REG.21/12/17	In force since December 2017, implemented between Liberia, The Gambia and Sierra Leone (2025-02), with full implementation by all mobile operators due by end-2025	A second three-state arrangement live, giving free incoming calls for up to 30 days and local rates on outgoing traffic; the end-2025 deadline passed with six of fifteen member states covered	ADVANCED, AGAINST A MISSED END-2025 DEADLINE
Regional certified electronic signature	Did not exist	The Commission has set out a programme towards a certified electronic signature usable across West Africa; no standard, root authority or member-state adoption is on file	ADVANCED
AES harmonised specifications for travel and identity documents	Validated and referred to the heads of state; no approval, gazetted text or reference number	Unchanged, while both credentials built on them are issued; no published text located	NO CHANGE

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

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This is a dated edition and is not revised after publication. If a figure here has moved, the current edition will say so.